

Business

1. Tesla recently reported its second-quarter earnings, and the results rattled investors enough to send shares down more than 3% after hours. What was the headline problem?
 - a. Revenue fell sharply despite strong car deliveries
 - b. Profits came in well below what Wall Street had expected
 - c. The company announced it was pausing all new model launches
2. AI is reshaping hiring across Europe, and job postings with AI-related titles have surged recently. But where are most of these AI jobs actually sitting?
 - a. In software engineering and data science teams
 - b. In non-tech roles like sales, marketing, and operations
 - c. In government and public sector organisations
3. Nike has been struggling in China, and it just made an aggressive move to fix its brand image there. The company recently announced it would cut off thousands of online distributors in the country. Why?
 - a. To comply with new Chinese regulations on foreign e-commerce platforms
 - b. To stabilise pricing and protect its brand by controlling where products are sold
 - c. To redirect sales through a single state-owned retail partner
4. Southwest Airlines pulled off a genuinely unusual logistics move this spring, prompted by worries about supply chain disruptions. What did it do?
 - a. Chartered a train to move aircraft parts from Dallas to Denver
 - b. Sent jet fuel from Houston to Los Angeles by ship for the first time
 - c. Stockpiled three months of fuel in underground tanks at LAX

Economics

5. The European Central Bank (the institution that sets interest rates for the 20 countries using the euro) recently held its benchmark rate at 2.25%, pausing after its first rate hike in three years. What event is now threatening to push rates higher again?
 - a. A sharp rise in German wage demands forcing up inflation forecasts
 - b. Renewed fighting in the Middle East pushing energy prices back up
 - c. A collapse in the euro's value against the US dollar

6. The US recently announced a new round of tariffs (taxes on imported goods) on dozens of countries, replacing a set that were expiring. The official justification was not the usual one. What reason did the Trump administration give?
 - a. Protecting American steel and aluminium from unfair subsidies
 - b. Concerns about forced labour practices in the targeted countries
 - c. Retaliating against countries that blocked US tech companies
7. Oil prices hit \$100 a barrel recently for the first time since May, rattling energy markets. Gulf oil producers are now spending billions on a specific infrastructure response. What are they building?
 - a. New deepwater drilling platforms in the Red Sea
 - b. Pipelines designed to route crude oil around the Strait of Hormuz
 - c. Floating liquefied natural gas terminals in the Arabian Sea
8. A recent report revealed the true scale of the gender pay gap (the difference between average earnings for men and women) across the European Union. How much do women in the EU collectively lose each year because of it?
 - a. Around €85 billion a year
 - b. Around €180 billion a year
 - c. Around €358 billion a year

General Knowledge

9. Which country is the world's largest producer of lithium, the metal at the heart of electric vehicle batteries and energy storage?
 - a. Chile
 - b. Australia
 - c. China
10. Which 18th-century economist wrote the line 'It is not from the benevolence of the butcher, the brewer, or the baker that we expect our dinner, but from their regard to their own interest'?
 - a. David Ricardo
 - b. Adam Smith
 - c. Thomas Malthus

Business

1. Tesla recently reported its second-quarter earnings, and the results rattled investors enough to send shares down more than 3% after hours. What was the headline problem?

b. Tesla's earnings per share missed Wall Street expectations by a significant margin. Revenue actually grew, which made the profit shortfall all the more striking — costs and the pivot toward robotics and AI are eating into margins. It's a reminder that a company can sell more and still disappoint the market if investors had priced in even better news.

2. AI is reshaping hiring across Europe, and job postings with AI-related titles have surged recently. But where are most of these AI jobs actually sitting?

b. The majority of AI-labelled jobs in European postings are now outside traditional tech occupations. Roles in sales, marketing, HR, and operations are increasingly tagged with AI skills as businesses expect everyone — not just engineers — to work alongside AI tools. This is a significant shift: the AI economy is becoming a general-purpose one, not a specialist enclave.

3. Nike has been struggling in China, and it just made an aggressive move to fix its brand image there. The company recently announced it would cut off thousands of online distributors in the country. Why?

b. Nike is cutting thousands of online distributors in China to regain control of how and where its products appear online. Too many third-party sellers create messy, inconsistent pricing — the kind that erodes a premium brand fast. It's a classic tension for big consumer brands in China: reach versus control. Nike is betting that fewer, more curated sales channels will help it claw back its reputation and margins.

4. Southwest Airlines pulled off a genuinely unusual logistics move this spring, prompted by worries about supply chain disruptions. What did it do?

b. Southwest hired a vessel to transport jet fuel by sea from Houston, Texas to Los Angeles — something the airline had never done before. It sounds like the plot of a logistics thriller, but it reflects genuine anxiety about fuel supply reliability on the US West Coast. Airlines run on razor-thin margins, so a fuel shortage at a major hub can be catastrophic. Hence: boats.

Economics

5. The European Central Bank (the institution that sets interest rates for the 20 countries using the euro) recently held its benchmark rate at 2.25%, pausing after its first rate hike in three years. What event is now threatening to push rates higher again?

b. Renewed conflict involving Iran has reignited concerns about energy supplies, pushing oil and gas prices higher across Europe. Since energy is a major driver of inflation (rising prices across the economy), this complicates the ECB's position. Policymakers had been enjoying a window of easing inflation that let them pause — that window may now be closing.

6. The US recently announced a new round of tariffs (taxes on imported goods) on dozens of countries, replacing a set that were expiring. The official justification was not the usual one. What reason did the Trump administration give?

b. The new tariffs — ranging from 10% to 12.5% — were framed around forced labour concerns rather than the more familiar trade-deficit or dumping arguments. It's a notable rhetorical shift: using human rights language to justify trade barriers gives the policy a moral framing that is harder to challenge at the World Trade Organization. Critics argue it is still straightforwardly protectionist, whatever the label.

7. Oil prices hit \$100 a barrel recently for the first time since May, rattling energy markets. Gulf oil producers are now spending billions on a specific infrastructure response. What are they building?

b. The Strait of Hormuz — a narrow waterway between Iran and Oman — is the chokepoint through which roughly 20% of the world's traded oil passes. Iran's ability to threaten or close that strait gives it enormous leverage. Gulf producers like Saudi Arabia and the UAE are accelerating pipeline projects that bypass it entirely, so that oil can reach tankers even if the strait is blocked. It's geography as geopolitics.

8. A recent report revealed the true scale of the gender pay gap (the difference between average earnings for men and women) across the European Union. How much do women in the EU collectively lose each year because of it?

c. The total comes to €358 billion annually — roughly €3,900 per woman per year. That figure is larger than the entire GDP of many European countries and makes the pay gap feel less like a statistical abstraction and more like a structural economic drain. Several EU member states recently missed the deadline to implement the bloc's Pay Transparency Directive, which was designed to start closing it.

General Knowledge

9. Which country is the world's largest producer of lithium, the metal at the heart of electric vehicle batteries and energy storage?

b. Australia is the world's largest lithium producer by volume, accounting for roughly half of global mine output, primarily from its vast hard-rock spodumene deposits in Western Australia. Chile holds the largest known reserves — most of it locked in salt flat brines — and is a close rival. China dominates lithium processing and battery manufacturing even though it mines far less of the raw material.

10. Which 18th-century economist wrote the line 'It is not from the benevolence of the butcher, the brewer, or the baker that we expect our dinner, but from their regard to their own interest'?

b. Adam Smith wrote those words in 'The Wealth of Nations', published in 1776 — the same year as the American Declaration of Independence. The passage is the most quoted summary of how market economies work: self-interest, channelled through prices and competition, tends to produce outcomes that benefit society even without anyone intending it. Smith called this coordinating force the 'invisible hand'.